

FIELD LIBRARY / ACTION CHECKLIST

# Do-not-use advisory

UTILITIES / EDITION 2026-10-02

**QUICK ANSWER / START HERE**

Do not drink or use tap water for any purpose while a do-not-use advisory is in effect. Avoid contact with skin, eyes and lungs. Use commercially bottled or officially approved alternatives and follow local instructions for sanitation.

## Do now.

☐**Stop tap-water use**

01

Do not bathe, wash dishes or use connected water and ice appliances.

☐**Get safe alternatives**

02

Check official water distribution and hygiene arrangements.

☐**Prevent accidental exposure**

03

Tell everyone in the household and keep children and pets from using taps.

☐**Follow restoration steps**

04

Wait for the official all-clear and complete any required flushing or appliance instructions.

# Keep the plan moving.

## IF HELP IS UNAVAILABLE

Make the unsafe supply physically obvious with signs and tell every person in the household. Use a separate clean-water container for essential washing. Avoid flushing or other contact unless the advisory specifically permits it; find another sanitation arrangement.

## Watch for.

Boiling does not override a do-not-use order.

## People & practical needs.

Make the restriction visible at every affected tap and brief every caregiver. Plan safe hygiene for infants, wounds, mobility needs and pets

## Next decision.

Plan temporary access to safe washing and sanitation if restrictions continue.

YOUR SITUATION / PRIVATE WORKSHEET

TIME / LOCATION / CHANGING CONDITIONS

PEOPLE / ACCESS OR MEDICAL NEEDS

SOURCES / SCOPE / LIMITS

Source-linked civilian guidance, not independent clinical or specialist certification. U.S. references; emergency numbers and services differ. Training and product instructions remain essential.

Do-not-use advisory · official guidance

Full guide: <https://ospreyzero.com/emergencies/do-not-use/>